

System

Story Context

The sheriff reaches the final system inside the house.

Old logs are still running...

Messages repeat:

they trusted me
they followed me
they never saw it coming

Something is hidden.

Not in code...

Not in files...

In the **pattern itself**

Objective

Analyze the logs and recover the **final flag revealing the truth**.

Files Provided

Description.txt

system.log

encoded.txt

Step 1 — Analyze the Logs

cat system.log

You'll see:

Day 10: S ubject secured
Day 11: H idden fear rising
Day 12: E veryone trusts me
Day 13: R outine maintained
Day 14: I move unseen
Day 15: F ollowing them closely
Day 16: F inal stage begins

Observation

Look at the **first letters**:

S
H
E
R
I
F
F

This spells:

SHERIFF

Meaning

The twist is revealed:

The Sheriff is the killer

Step 2 — Analyze Encoded File

`cat encoded.txt`

You'll see:

- Base64 encoded data
- A fake flag:

`THM{system_compromised}`

This is a **decoy**

Step 3 — Identify Encoding

The long string:

`UEsDB...`

This is **Base64**

Step 4 — Decode (Handle Noise)

`base64 -d encoded.txt > out.zip 2>/dev/null`

`2>/dev/null` ignores errors caused by fake flag

Step 5 — Extract ZIP

unzip out.zip

Output:

final_flag.txt

Step 6 — Get Final Flag

cat final_flag.txt

✓ Final flag:

THM{the_sheriff_is_the_killer}

Questions

1. What hidden word is revealed by analyzing the pattern in the system logs?

Ans: sheriff

2. What encoding method is used in the encoded file?

Ans: base64

3. What type of file is obtained after decoding the encoded data?

Ans: zip

4. What is the final flag revealing the truth?

Ans: THM{the_sheriff_is_the_killer}